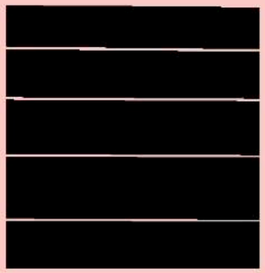
COMMUNITY

DIRTY WORD [REPORT #4]

PROTEIN DIRTY WORD
REPORT #4
$PRTN





DIRTY WORD: “COMMUNITY”
REPORT #4

CERTAIN BUZZWORDS HAVE COME TO DOMINATE CONVERSATIONS ON CULTURE AND SOCIETY.

As the “DIRTY WORD” is used and its new meaning proliferates, it gathers cultural baggage and becomes increasingly narrow in definition.
We want to take a step back and re-focus on the usage of these words. The intention is not to reach an objective definition of each “DIRTY WORD,” but to explore concept and context to build a foundation for discussion.



DIRTY WORDS #1:
EXCLUSIVITY
2018



DIRTY WORDS #2:
INFLUENCE
2021

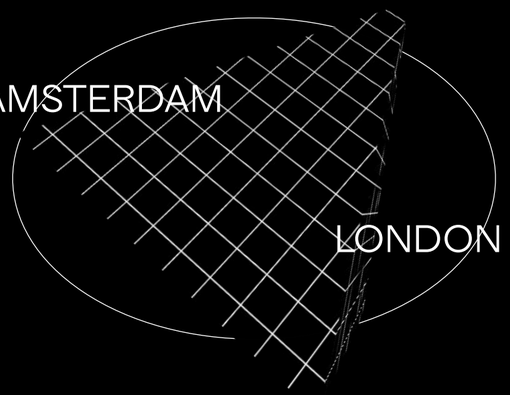


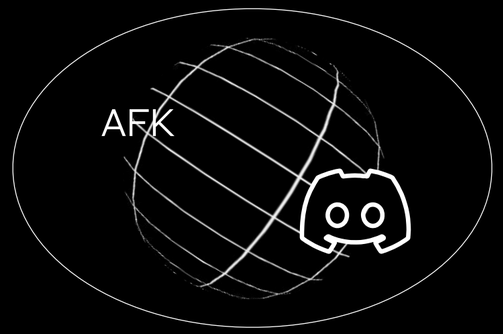
DIRTY WORDS #3:
OWNERSHIP
2022

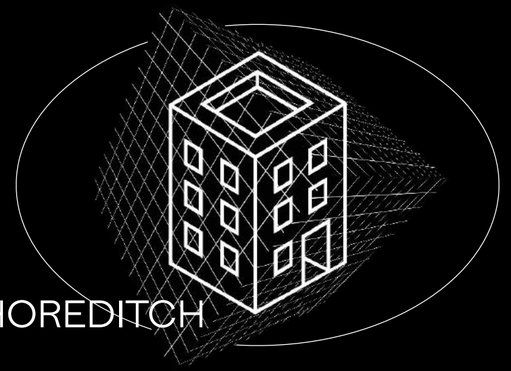


DIRTY WORDS #4:
COMMUNITY
2023

PROTEIN ECOSYSTEM







AGENCY

COMMUNITY

STUDIOS

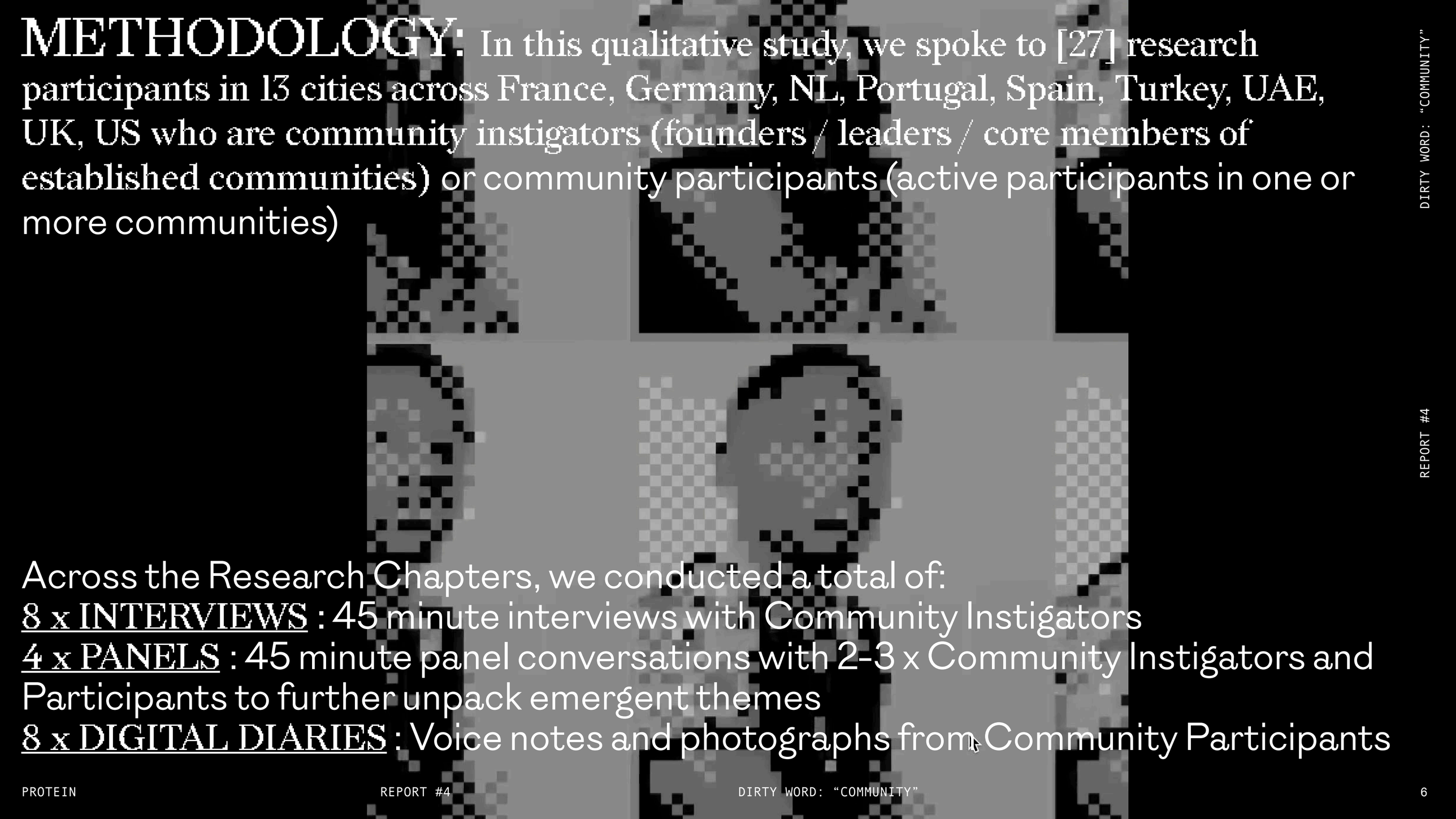
SHAPE OF THIS COLLABORATION



BOUNTIFIED *
Paid tasks set by a community
for members to claim

REPORT INTENTIONS: As a Community and Agency working in collaboration, we collectively established the following intentions to guide us in the research and production of this report:

____[1]To provide tangible advice and resources for building healthier communities and how to actively support them.____[2]To suggest a new (evolving) definition of community that prioritises belonging and co-ownership. ____[3] To create a space for members to share mutual perspectives and learnings between different communities.



METHODOLOGY: In this qualitative study, we spoke to [27] research participants in 13 cities across France, Germany, NL, Portugal, Spain, Turkey, UAE, UK, US who are community instigators (founders / leaders / core members of established communities) or community participants (active participants in one or more communities)

Across the Research Chapters, we conducted a total of:
8 x INTERVIEWS : 45 minute interviews with Community Instigators
4 x PANELS : 45 minute panel conversations with 2-3 x Community Instigators and Participants to further unpack emergent themes
8 x DIGITAL DIARIES : Voice notes and photographs from Community Participants

WHY IS COMMUNITY A DIRTY WORD?

The top voted themes by our Community pointed to; the commodification of community and the fundamental lack of authentic community experiences. A lot of this is being driven by brands and social media.

APPROPRIATION **EXTRACTIVE BEHAVIOURS HYPER INDIVIDUALISATION**COMMODIFICATION + MONETISATION ** TRANSACTIONAL** INAUTHENTIC ** POWER SHARING (LACK OF) ** SUBCULTURES (LACK OF) **


I SEE YOU ARE THINKING ABOUT STARTING AN ONLINE COMMUNITY
I TOO LIKE TO LIVE DANGEROUSLY


JUST MAKING SURE THAT
YOU AREN'T VIOLATING COMMUNITY STANDARDS


What's the first thing
you notice when a man approaches you?


Name a more toxic community, I'll wait


EVIDENCE
Whether he is a member of Itheum Community

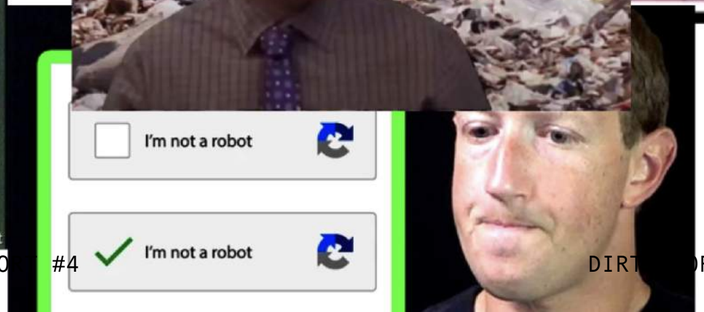

COMMUNITY MANAGER
my friends think I do.
What my mom thinks I do.
What I think I do.
What society thinks I do.
Spammy Users
What I really do.


when a fashion brand wants to work with us & we say we're taking a little field trip

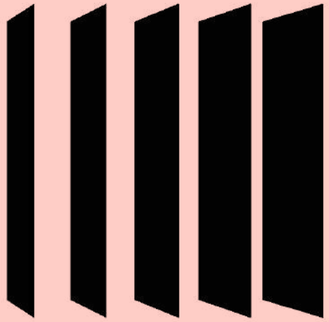

IMAGINE A WORLD
WITHOUT FACEBOOK


BUILD YOUR OWN DAMN BRIDGE LIKE I DID!
WITH WHAT?!
Capitalism at its finest

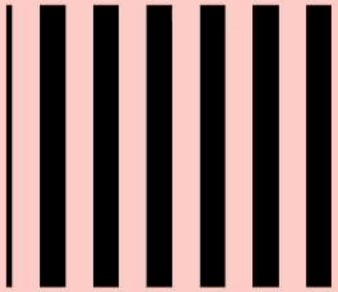

THE HUMAN SOUL
UNDER LATE CAPITALISM
memegenerator.net


I'm not a robot
I'm not a robot

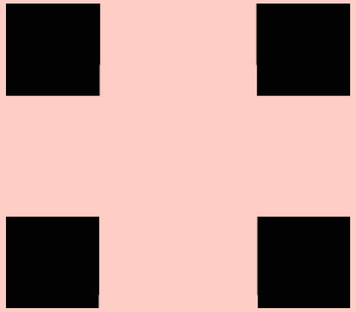

YO WHY ARE THEY SHARING RESOURCES
WITH NO PROFIT INCENTIVE



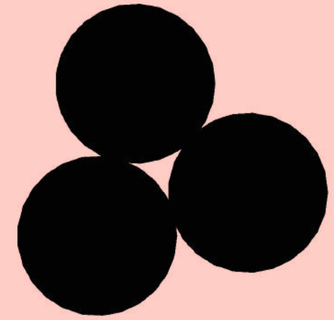
FOUNDATIONS



IDENTITIES



SPACES

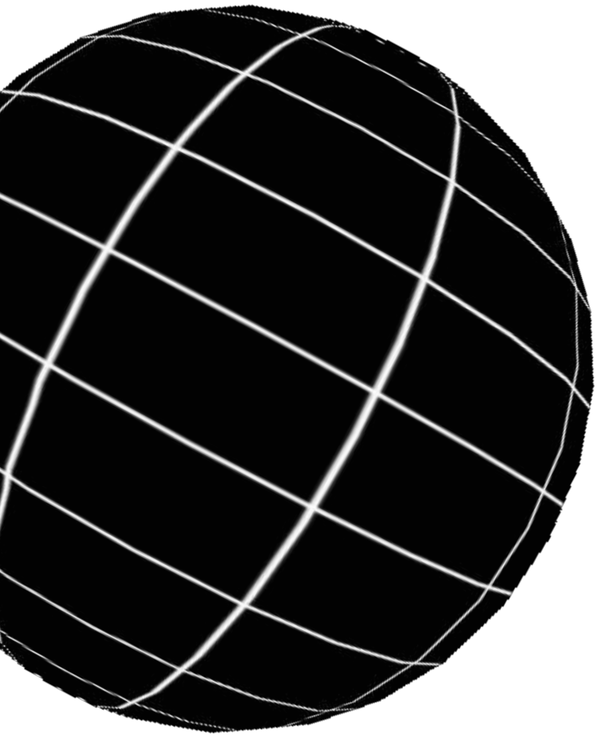


ECONOMIES

OUR RESEARCH GROUPS EXAMINED COMMUNITY FROM FOUR INTERRELATED AND FUNDAMENTAL ANGLES AND SET THEIR OWN FOCUSED RESEARCH OBJECTIVES.

HERE IS A TASTE OF *WHAT WE LEARNED*

WEB 2 AND WEB 3 REPRESENT HUGE SHIFTS IN HOW COMMUNITY IS EXPERIENCED AND UNDERSTOOD



WEB 2

- Community no longer defined by geography
- Created mass platforms for Communities to gather, organise and communicate
- Contributed to the demise of subcultures
- Influencers and click counts define Community relevance

AFK

- Amidst the hyper-virtualisation of society, people are looking for meaningful physical spaces to commune

WEB 3

- Operationalises co-ownership and co-governance for Communities
- Facilitates niches
- Decentralises community infrastructure
- Creates new forms of elitism e.g. ‘crypto bros’

“The digital space is very good for discovery. And the physical space is very good for commitment.”

–

ELIE ANDERSEN
USA



THE TOOLS AND GEOS OF COMMUNITY ARE CHANGING, BUT THE CHARACTERISTICS OF AUTHENTIC COMMUNITY EXPERIENCES ARE ROOTED IN HUMAN VALUES

“Community is ultimately a form and a materialisation of presence, connectedness and purpose.”

—

CAIT CMO
UK

WHAT IS COMMUNITY?

WHAT IS COMMUNITY?

From all the definitions offered these characteristics were the most commonly shared (curated in collaboration with Chat GPT).

PRESENCE
Communities are a space where people are actively engaged

SAFETY AND BELONGING
Communities provide a space where members can be themselves

FAMILY AND HOME
Communities provide a feeling of home and familiarity

IDENTITY
Community gives us a sense of self and a coherent place in the world

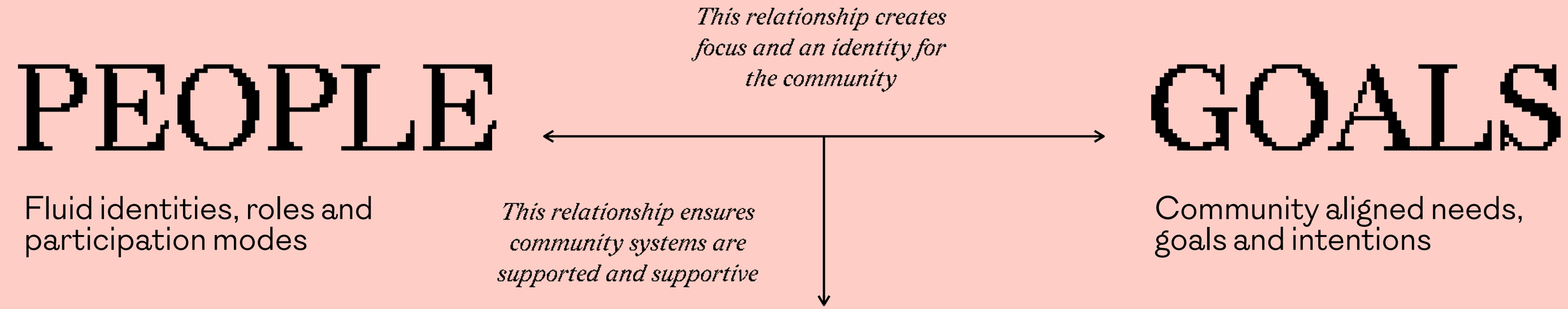
PURPOSE AND PRINCIPLES
Communities have a common goal or shared purpose

SUPPORTIVE CONNECTION
Communities are an ecosystem of support

CENTRE OF INTEREST
Communities are rooted in common interest or values

COLLABORATION AND EXCHANGE
Communities share resources (beyond financial)

A RESTORATIVE CONCEPT OF COMMUNITY CENTRES THE RECIPROCAL RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN PEOPLE, THEIR SHARED GOALS AND NEEDS, WHERE TECHNOLOGY IS IN SERVICE OF, BUT NOT DRIVING THAT.



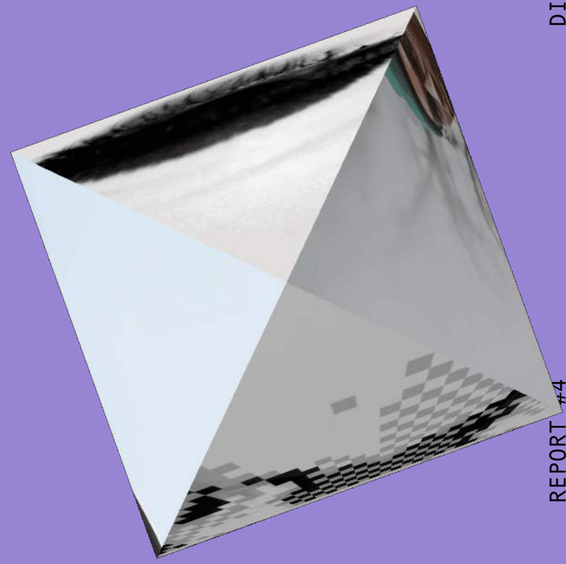
COMMUNITY LEADERS HAVE THE ROLE OF NURTURING AND MAINTAINING EQUILIBRIUM ACROSS THESE RELATIONSHIPS AS THINGS INEVITABLY CHANGE AND EVOLVE.

Community caretakers need to be highly valued and better-resourced. This is a role, or function that need to be taken seriously.



From “LEADER” ⟶
to “BUILDER”, “GARDERNER”, “NURTURER”

Down-time, conflict resolution, off-boarding and exiting - are all an inevitable part of community ecosystems.



“[We] need to take our breaks, to replenish, to strengthen our heart muscles, and come back into the world more authentic and be able to give more.”

–
ZAINA KANA'AN
UAE

Engagement is about INTENTIONALITY, not intensity.

“You need different participation pathways to actually **meaningfully contribute** to your community. If you only have one, that's problematic. If the only way that you can become a member is in one way and you have to pay for it, I would challenge you.”
–
RAFAEL FERNÁNDEZ,
GERMANY



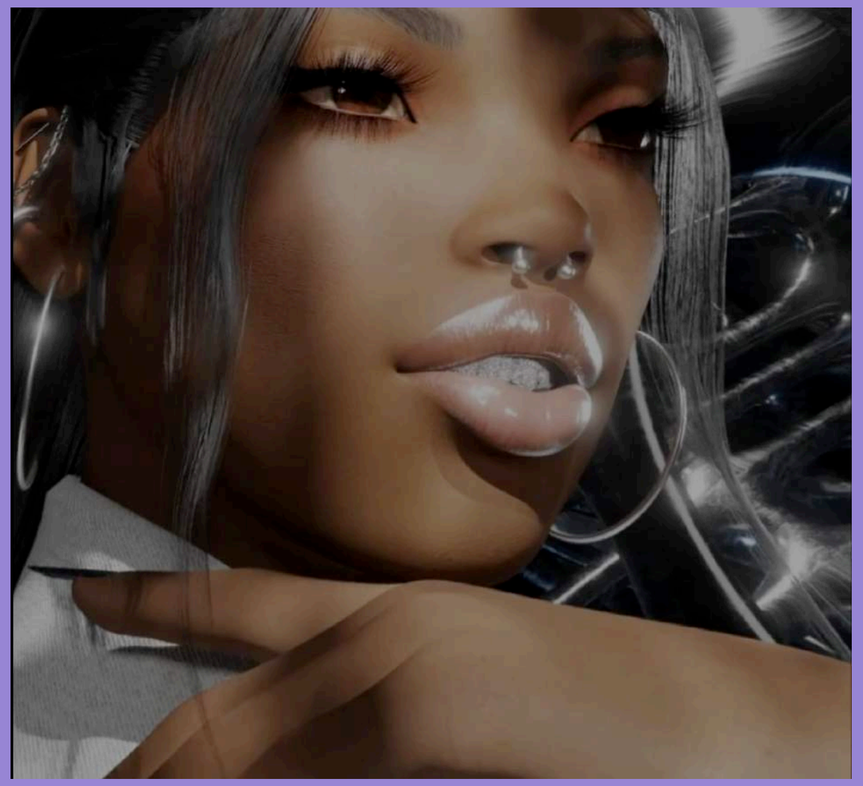
“If there are people with a lot of social and financial capital, people assume that the community is automatically good, which isn’t necessarily the case. You can get a group of people who have a lot of either of those things, but they might not be aligned on the goals of the community, or maybe they don’t have the time or interest to actually contribute.”
–
JOHN KUFOUR (KOFI)
UK

Community provides a sandbox for PLAYING with identity. Members can find spaces to FEEL EVEN MORE THEMSELVES.

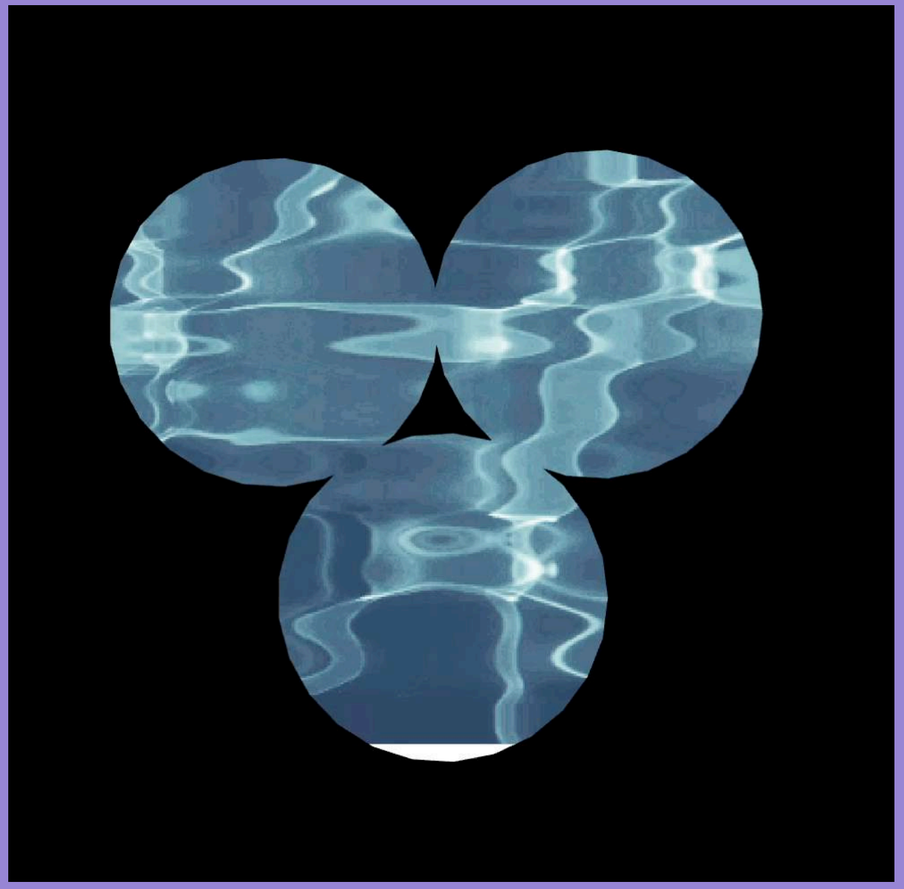
“In my culture, you have to be this one thing your whole entire life.... that's so boring. The metaverse and the people that I'm with, they're like, ‘You can be all of these things. You can do all these things. And we'll help you. You can explore these different things. You can chop off things that no longer work. This idea that we can be these flexible beings with these layers of identities has been so freeing to me, to just be myself to the fullest extent.”

–

NATALIE J. CRÜE
USA



Participating in MUTUALLY BENEFICIAL EXCHANGE is all part of the appeal. And this goes beyond financial exchange.



"A community is defined by its boundaries, then within that bounded space there's a spirit of reciprocity and generosity and its not about counting."

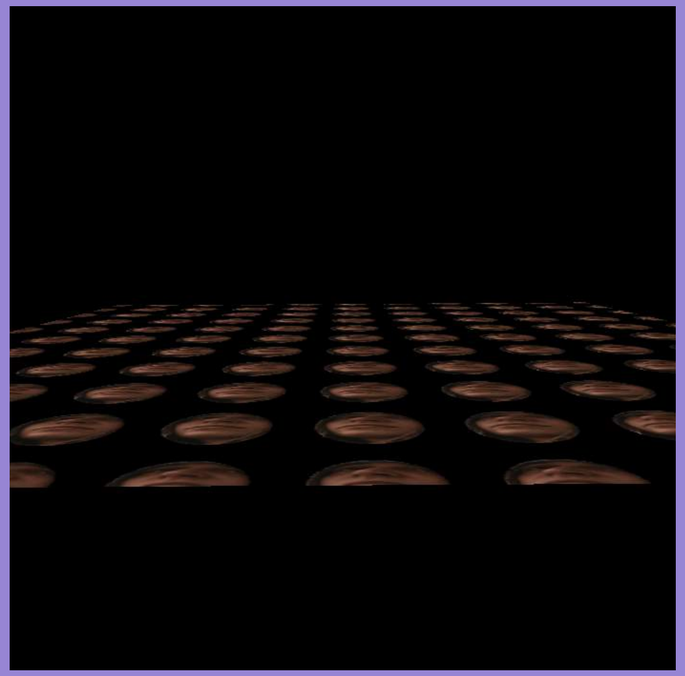
–

RICH BARTLETT
UK

TRANSPARENCY and clear intentions AROUND THE USE AND EXCHANGE OF RESOURCES = a healthy community economy.

“If it's just a bunch of people hanging out, then suddenly there's money - who gets the money? That's a perfect way to turn something that used to be fun into, now we're fighting over who gets paid to do what in this thing that was just meant to be fun. [...] **I didn't come here to be a customer of a business, I didn't come here to run the business, that isn't what I came for.**”

–
JOHN KUFOUR (KOFI)
UK



WE LEARNED THAT COMMUNITIES OF ALL TYPES NEED TO BALANCE CLARITY WITH FLEXIBILITY.



Motivate participation through clarity by having clear intentions, goals and feedback.

Adapt and grow around members and alongside their evolving needs, in response to internal and external factors.

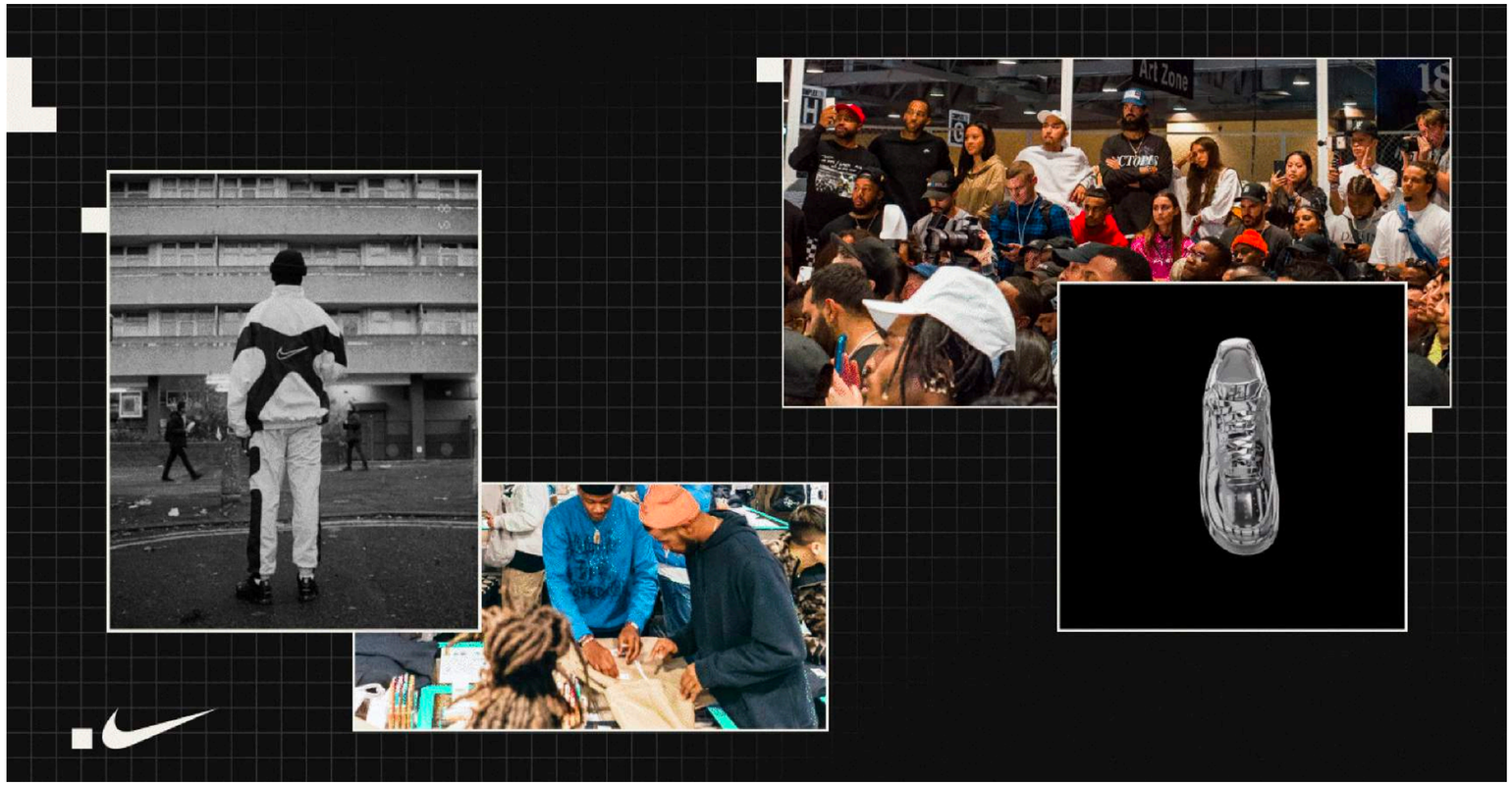
BRANDS NEED TO THINK DIFFERENTLY *ABOUT THE VALUE OF COMMUNITIES*

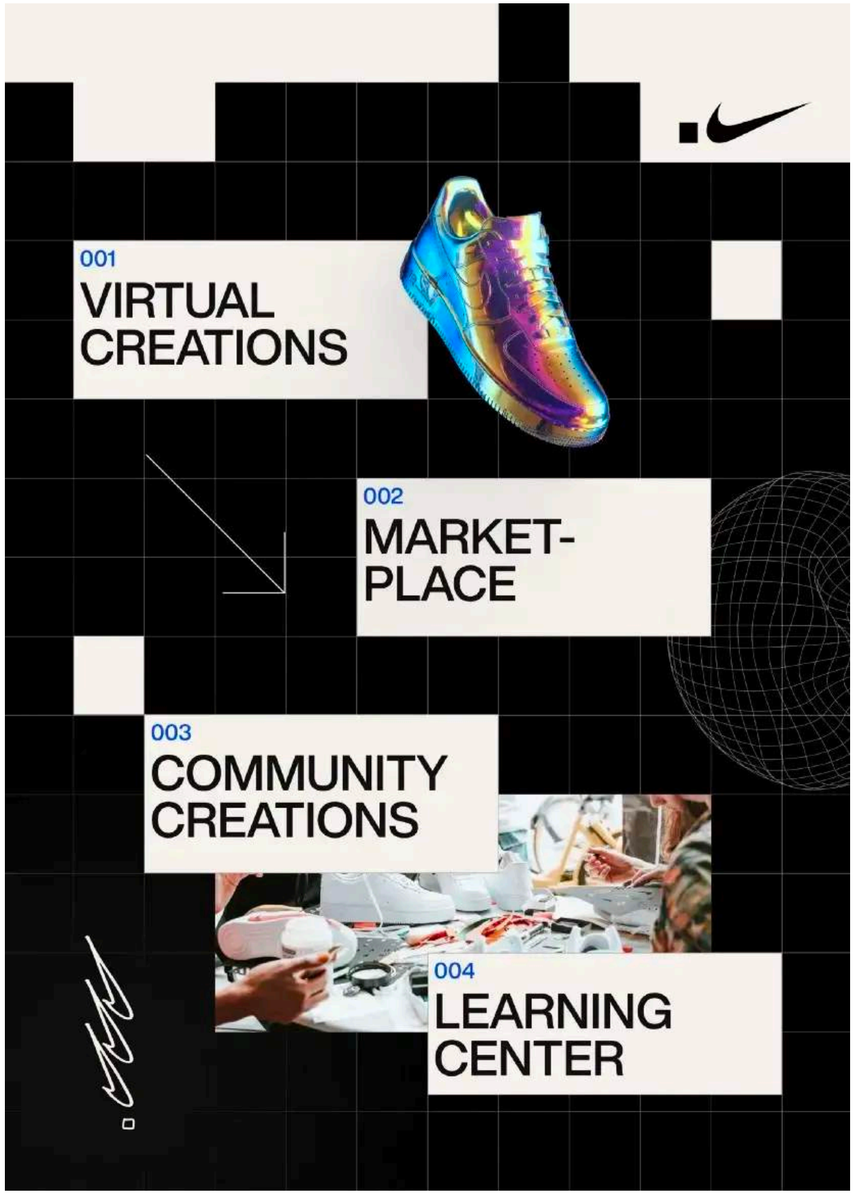
FROM:
CONSUMER / USER GROUP

TO:
ECOSYSTEM OF INFLUENCE

CASE STUDY

From: CONSUMER /USER GROUP ⟶ To: ECOSYSTEM OF INFLUENCE





.SWOOSH

FROM:
EXPRESSION OF BRAND LOYALTY

TO:
EXPRESSION OF LIVING AND EVOLVING VALUES

CASE STUDY

From: EXPRESSION OF BRAND LOYALTY ⟶ To: EXPRESSION OF LIVING AND EVOLVING VALUES





TELFAR

FROM:
BENEFACTORS OF BRAND PURPOSE

TO:
COMPASS FOR IMPACT

CASE STUDY

From: BENEFACTORS OF BRAND PURPOSE ⟶ To: COMPASS FOR IMPACT

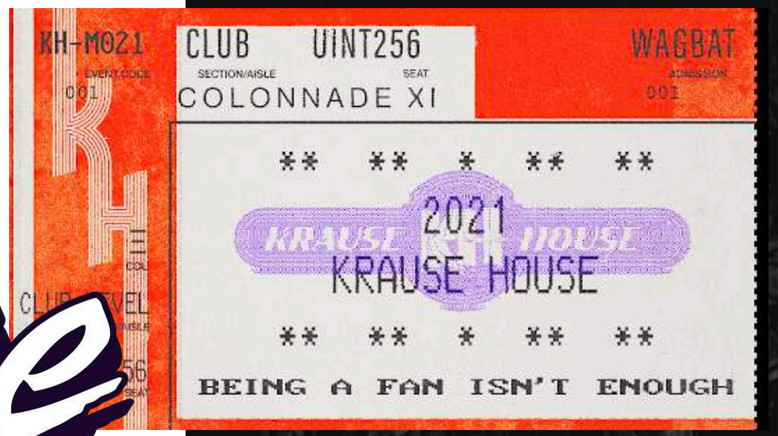


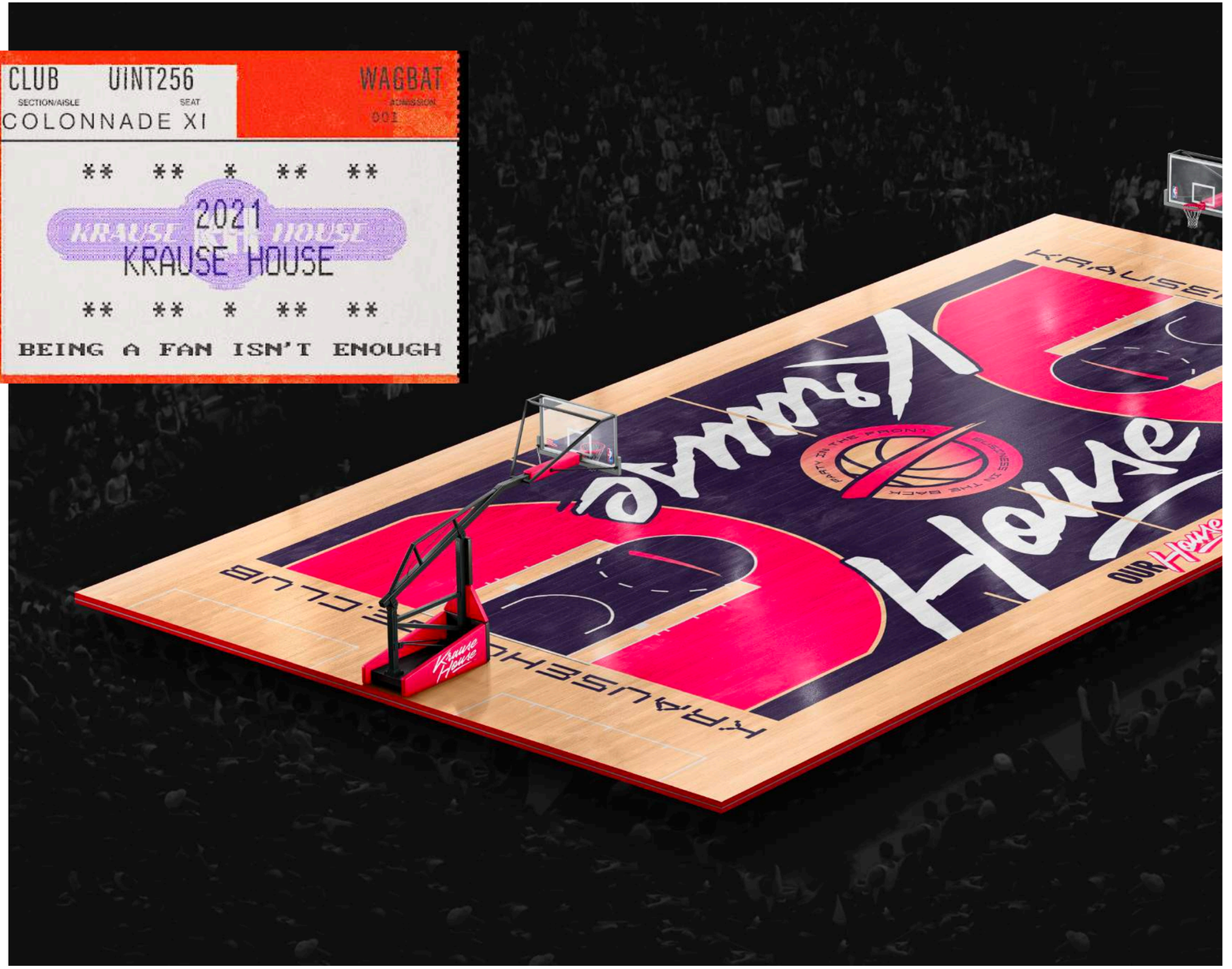


SOFTER

FROM: TREND TRIBES → TO: CULTURAL STAKEHOLDERS

CASE STUDY





Krause House™

KRAUSE HOUSE

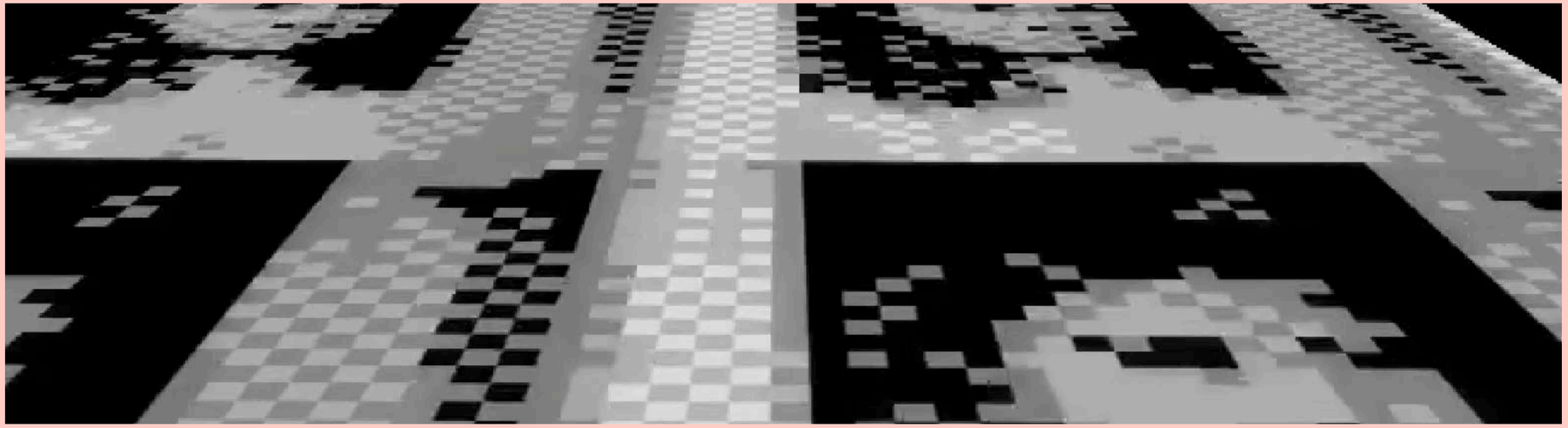
FROM:	TO:
EXPRESSION OF BRAND LOYALTY	*ECOSYSTEM OF INFLUENCE*
CONSUMER / USER GROUP	*EXPRESSION OF LIVING AND EVOLVING BRAND VALUES*
BENEFACTORS OF BRAND PURPOSE	*COMPASS FOR IMPACT*
TREND TRIBES	*CULTURAL STAKEHOLDERS*

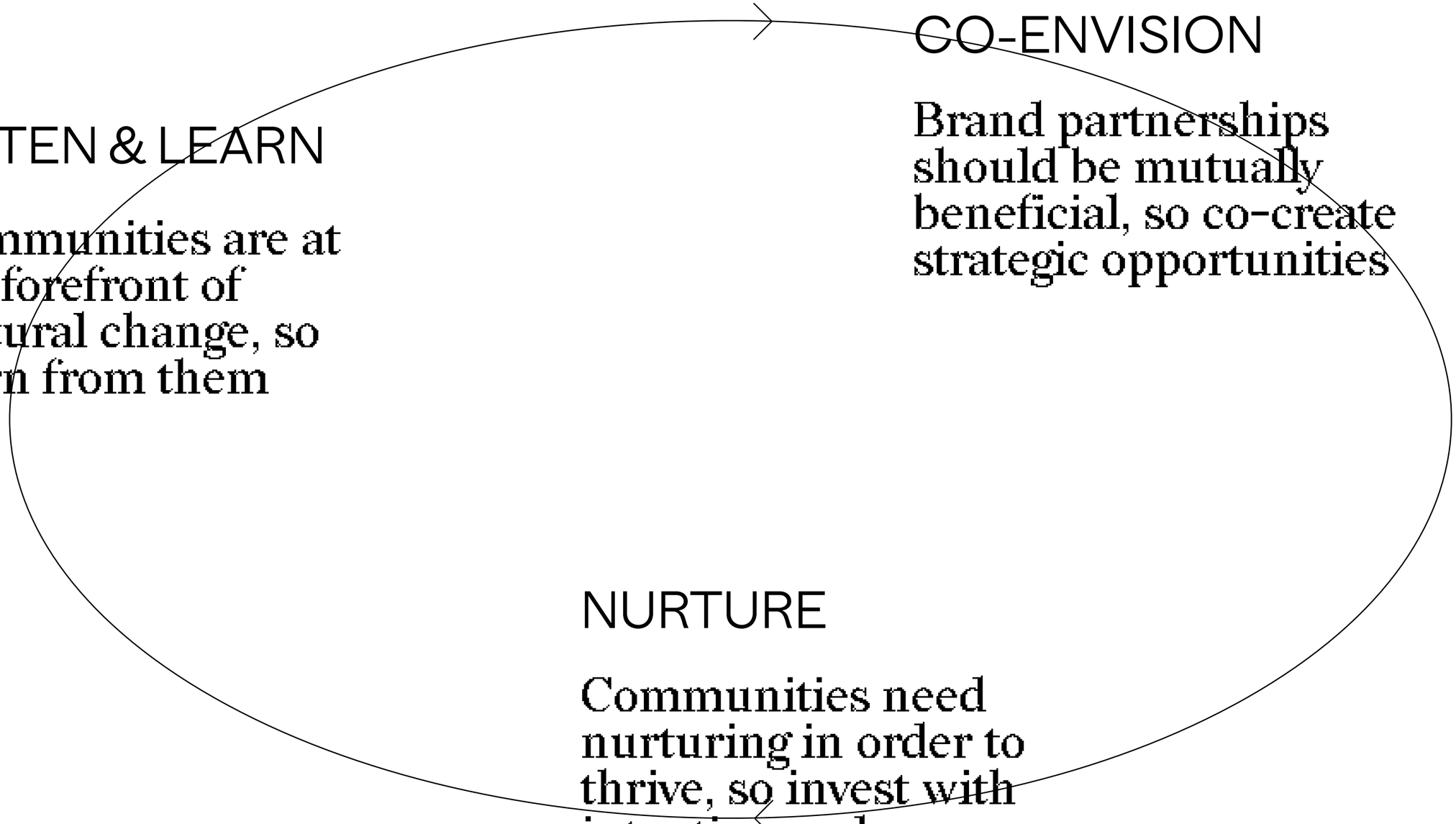
HOW CAN BRANDS RESTORE THE *VALUE IN COMMUNITY PARTNERSHIPS?*

“It's about sharing control. What is the outcome when a brand successfully partners with a subculture or community? The culture and expression of that community has to come first. In terms of a collab, it's the community name that comes first, not the brand name [...] the energy, the shape, the form, the function has to come from the community”

—

NIC ALLUM
USA





LISTEN & LEARN

Communities are at the forefront of cultural change, so learn from them

CO-ENVISION

Brand partnerships should be mutually beneficial, so co-create strategic opportunities

NURTURE

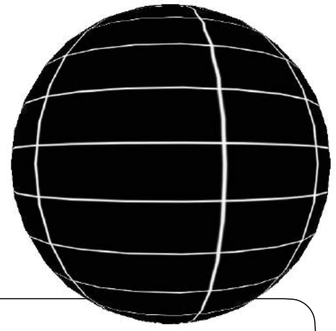
Communities need nurturing in order to thrive, so invest with intention and care

HOWTOs FOR A MUTUALLY BENEFICIAL COMMUNITY STRATEGY

LISTEN TO THE COMMUNITY

SHARE YOUR EXPERTISE

CREATE TRANSPARENCY



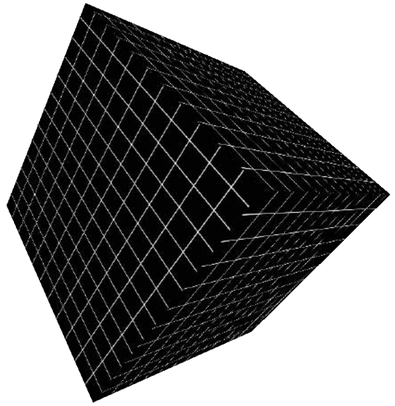
COLLECTIVELY SET INTENTIONS

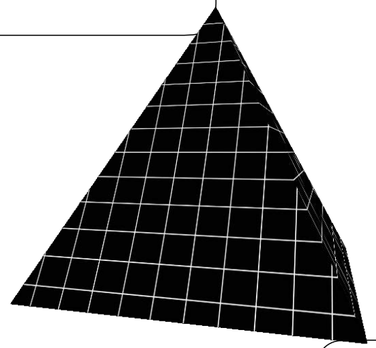
THINK ABOUT THE LIFE CYCLE OF THE COMMUNITY

PROVIDE SUSTAINABLE RESOURCES

BE A SANDBOX FOR EXPRESSION

ENABLE MEANINGFUL PARTICIPATION





CHAMPION AND INVEST IN CARE

BE FLEXIBLE AND ADAPTABLE

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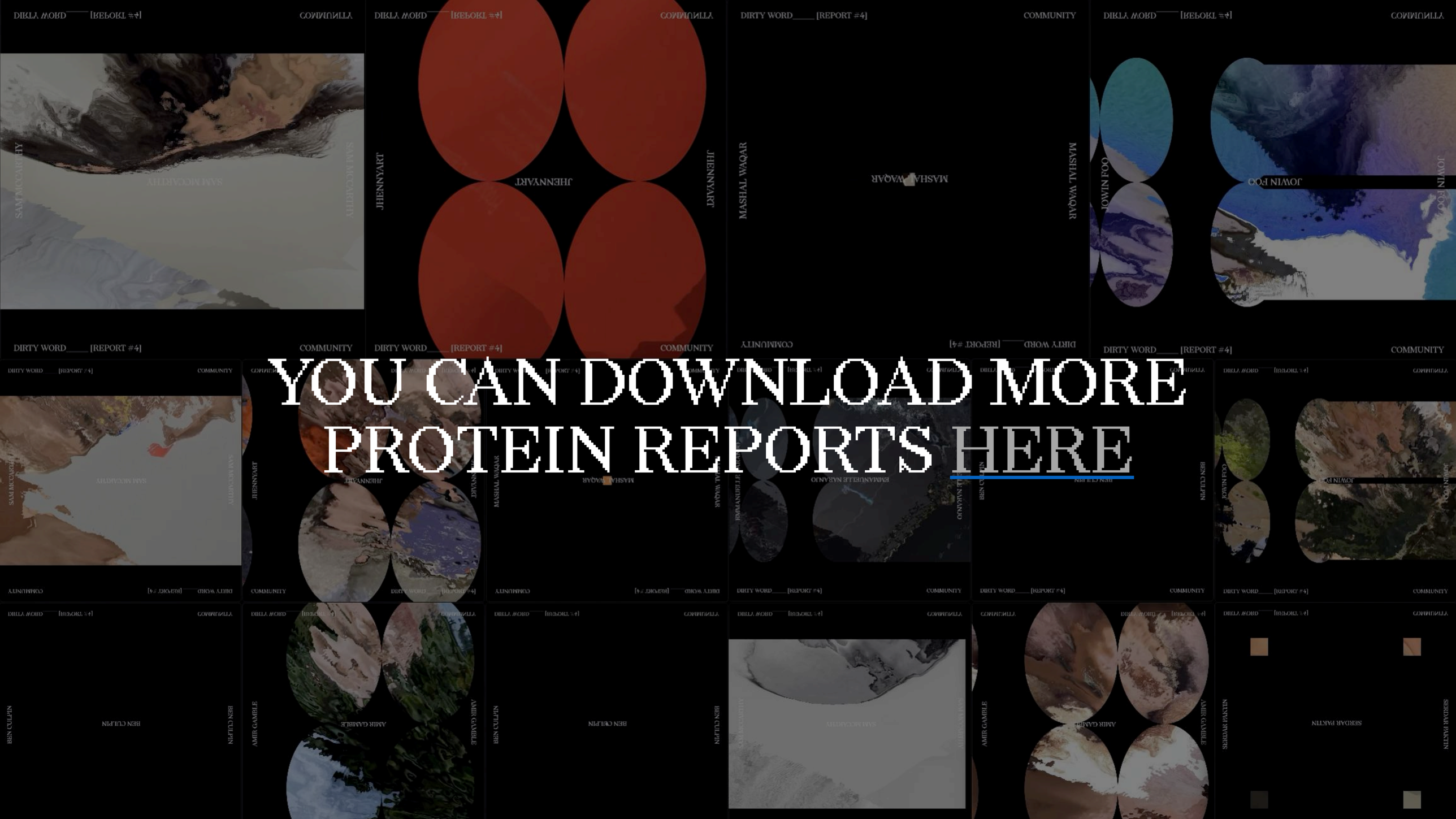
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Member who joined our weekly
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COMMUNITY

DIRTY WORD
[REPORT #4]

PROTEIN DIRTY WORD
REPORT #4
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